

WHAT DO OTHERS SEE CHANGING?

GOALS OF THE EXERCISE

1. Maintain a program of recovery free of addiction and negative influences from peers.
2. Learn the skills necessary to develop a new peer group that is addiction free and supportive of working a program of recovery.
3. Become more aware of positive changes and progress in treatment by getting feedback from other people.
4. Increase emotional support from others.

ADDITIONAL HOMEWORK THAT CAN BE APPLICABLE TO CLIENTS WHO EXPERIENCE PEER GROUP NEGATIVITY

- Analyzing Acting-Out Behavior
- Being Genuinely Unselfish
- Building My Support Network
- Consequences of Continuing Addictive Lifestyles
- Relapse Prevention Planning
- Setting and Maintaining Boundaries
- Using My Support Network
- What Do I Need and How Do I Get It?
- What Price Am I Willing to Pay?

ADDITIONAL PROBLEM FOR WHICH THIS EXERCISE MAY BE USEFUL

- Depression

SUGGESTIONS FOR PROCESSING THIS EXERCISE WITH THE CLIENT

The “What Do Others See Changing?” activity is intended to correct distorted self-perceptions that feed into social isolation, depression, and low self-esteem, and to lead the client into connecting with others in healthy ways in the process of carrying out the exercise. Its approach is to guide the client in selecting several people from whom to get feedback on changes as a result of recovery work, log their responses, and share that information with the therapist, group, and program sponsor. Follow-up

may include repeating this activity at set intervals, perhaps quarterly, and again sharing the responses, as well as discussing differences between the client's self-perception and the way he or she is perceived by peers.

WHAT DO OTHERS SEE CHANGING?

Sometimes it's hard to measure change in our lives. Feedback from others can help us see our own progress more clearly. This exercise will guide you in gathering feedback from people who are close to you, who support your recovery efforts, and whom you trust.

1. List 10 people you will ask for feedback about changes they see in you and your life.

_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____

2. What will you ask them? You might want feedback about your relationships, work/school performance, moods, appearance, or health. Write your questions here.

3. Record the feedback you receive here.

Who I Asked	What He/She Told Me

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Be sure to bring this handout to your next therapy session, and be prepared to talk about your thoughts and feelings about the exercise.